

An ivory monument of eternal love on the banks of the Yamuna

At a Glance

State	Uttar Pradesh
City	Agra
UNESCO	World Heritage Site since 1983
Best Time	October – March
Airport	Agra Airport / Delhi IGI (~200 km)
Built	1632–1653 CE by Emperor Shah Jahan

Overview

The Taj Mahal stands on the right bank of the Yamuna as the undisputed crown jewel of Indian architectural heritage. Commissioned by Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan in memory of his beloved wife Mumtaz Mahal, this mausoleum took 22 years and 20,000 artisans to build. It is universally recognised as one of the New Seven Wonders of the World and receives over 7 million visitors annually.

Constructed from translucent white Makrana marble inlaid with 28 types of precious and semi-precious stones using the pietra dura technique, the Taj Mahal's appearance shifts dramatically through the day — blushing pink at dawn, luminous white at noon, and glowing amber-gold under the full moon. Its perfect symmetry and serene garden setting make it an architectural masterpiece that centuries have failed to diminish.

Top Attractions

Main Mausoleum & Central Dome

The iconic central dome soars 73 metres into the sky; its interior houses the cenotaphs of Shah Jahan and Mumtaz Mahal, surrounded by intricate jali (lattice) screens of white marble, inlaid with floral motifs in precious stones, and verses from the Quran.



■ *Main Mausoleum & Central Dome*

Agra Fort

Just 2.5 km from the Taj, this massive red-sandstone UNESCO World Heritage Site served as the principal residence of the Mughal emperors from Akbar to Aurangzeb. Shah Jahan spent his final years imprisoned here, gazing at the Taj from the Musamman Burj tower.



■ *Agra Fort*

Fatehpur Sikri

A remarkably preserved Mughal ghost city 37 km from Agra — Akbar's palatial capital abandoned after only 14 years, possibly due to water scarcity. Another UNESCO Heritage Site.



■ *Fatehpur Sikri*

Mehtab Bagh (Moonlit Garden)

Cross the Yamuna to this 16th-century octagonal garden, perfectly aligned with the Taj's central axis — it offers the most dramatic sunset silhouette of the Taj Mahal in existence.



■ *Mehtab Bagh (Moonlit Garden)*

Local Cuisine & Flavours

- Petha — Agra's iconic semi-translucent ash-gourd sweet available in over 100 flavours
- Bedai & Jalebi — the classic Agra breakfast; crispy puffed bread with spiced potato filling
- Mughlai Biryani, Nihari & Korma from old-city restaurants near Taj Ganj
- Dalmoth — Agra's spiced crispy lentil snack mix, the best souvenir from the city
- Shahi Tukda — royal bread pudding soaked in milk & saffron, a Mughal court dessert

How to Get There

- By Air: Agra Airport (limited); Delhi IGI (200 km) better connected to all cities.
- By Train: Gatimaan Express (Delhi–Agra in 100 mins) is the fastest train in India.
- By Road: 200 km from Delhi via Yamuna Expressway (~2 hrs).
- By Taxi: Pre-booked cabs from Delhi or Jaipur are the most popular option.

Insider Travel Tips

- Arrive at sunrise — best light, fewest crowds, and the Taj blushes a magical pink.
- The Taj is closed every Friday for prayers — plan your visit on any other day.
- Buy the ASI combo ticket (Taj Mahal + Agra Fort) to save money at both sites.
- Photography inside the main mausoleum chamber is strictly prohibited.
- Wear comfortable shoes — you'll walk a lot and must wear shoe covers inside the mausoleum.

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*We hope this guide inspires your journey to **Taj Mahal — Agra**. Travel responsibly, respect local traditions, and leave only footprints.*